

3.2.2 Socio-cultural influences

Students should develop knowledge and understanding of the socio-cultural factors that impact on physical activity and sport, and the impact of sport on society.

3.2.2.1 Engagement patterns of different social groups in physical activity and sport

Content	Additional information
Engagement patterns of different social groups and the factors affecting participation	Engagement patterns in physical activity and sport can differ between different social groups. Understand factors that contribute to engagement patterns in the following social groups: • gender • race/religion/culture • age • family/friends/peers • disability. Students should be taught to make justifiable links between the following factors and their relevance to engagement patterns of the groups above: • attitudes • role models • accessibility (to facilities/clubs/activities) • media coverage • sexism/stereotyping • culture/religion/religious festivals • family commitments • available leisure time • familiarity • education • socio-economic factors/disposable income • adaptability/inclusiveness.

3.2.2.2 Commercialisation of physical activity and sport

Content	Additional information
Commercialisation	Definition of commercialisation. The relationship between sport, sponsorship and the media.

Content	Additional information
Types of sponsorship and the media	Definitions of sponsorship and the media. Types of sponsorship: • financial • clothing and equipment, including footwear • facilities. Types of media: • television • radio • the press • the internet • social media.
Positive and negative impacts of sponsorship and the media	The positive and the negative impacts of commercialised activity (sponsorship and the media) on the following: • performer • sport • official • audience/spectator • sponsor/company. Students should be taught to justify why the impact is positive and/or negative.
Positive and negative impacts of technology	The positive and the negative impacts of technology on the following: • performer • sport • official • audience/spectator • sponsor/company. Students should be taught to justify why the impact is positive and/or negative. Teaching should make students aware of examples of technology used in sport (eg Hawkeye, Television Match Official). However, the focus should be on technology generically, not on specific types of technology (eg Hawkeye, Television Match Official).

3.2.2.3 Ethical and socio-cultural issues in physical activity and sport

Content	Additional information
Conduct of performers	Definitions of the following terms: • etiquette • sportsmanship • gamesmanship • contract to compete. Students should be taught sporting examples of these terms.
Prohibited substances	Categories of prohibited substances, including the basic positive effects and negative side effects: • stimulants • narcotic analgesics • anabolic agents • peptide hormones (EPO) • diuretics.
Prohibited methods (blood doping)	How blood doping occurs and the effects/side effects of doing it. Blood doping involves the removal of blood a few weeks prior to competition. The blood is frozen and re-injected just before competition. Students should be taught how blood doping leads to increased red blood cell count and be able to evaluate which types of sporting performers this could benefit. Side effects can be: • thickening of blood (viscosity) • potential infection • potential for heart attack • embolism (blockage of vessel).

Content	Additional information
Drugs subject to certain restrictions (beta blockers)	Beta blockers are taken to: • reduce heart rate, muscle tension and blood pressure • reduce the effects of adrenaline • improve fine control/preciseness. Side effects can lead to: • nausea • weakness • heart problems. Beta blockers should be prescribed by a medical professional.
Which type of performers may use different types of performance enhancing drugs (PEDs) with sporting examples	Stimulants – alertness Narcotic analgesics – pain killers from over training Anabolic agents – muscle mass Diuretics – lose weight Peptide hormones – oxygen carrying capacity Blood doping – oxygen carrying capacity Beta blockers – for fine motor control Students should be taught to understand in which sports performers may decide to use PEDs, with examples.
The advantages and disadvantages for the performer of taking PEDs	Advantages include: • increased chances of success • fame • wealth • level playing field. Disadvantages include: • cheating/immoral • associated health risks • fines • bans • reputational damage.
The disadvantages to the sport/event of performers taking PEDs	Disadvantages include: • reputation • credibility.

Content	Additional information
Spectator behaviour (the positive and the negative effects of spectators at events)	The positive influence of spectators at matches/ events: • creation of atmosphere • home-field advantage (for home team/ individuals). The negative influence of spectators at matches/events: • negative effect on performance as a result of increased pressure • potential for crowd trouble/hooliganism • safety costs/concerns • negative effect on participation numbers amongst younger performers.
Reasons why hooliganism occurs	Reasons for hooliganism: • rivalries • hype • fuelled by alcohol/drugs • gang culture • frustration (eg at official's decisions) • display of masculinity.
Strategies employed to combat hooliganism/ spectator behaviour	Strategies include: • early kick-offs • all-seater stadia • segregation of fans • improved security • alcohol restrictions • travel restrictions/banning orders • education/promotional activity/campaigns and high profile endorsements. Students should be taught to evaluate the effectiveness of these strategies, eg high costs of security versus safety of spectators.